

ART AND CULTURE



LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE

CLASSIFICATION OF INDIAN LANGUAGES

MODULE – 1



LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INTRODUCTION

- 1 Language in its literary meaning is a **system of communication through speech**, a collection of sounds that a group of people understand to have the same meaning.

LANGUAGE

DIALECT

DIALECT:

It is a **form of language spoken in local area**. It should be noted that several dialects can be derived from a particular language.



LANGUAGE FAMILY

A LANGUAGE FAMILY:

It includes **individual languages related through a common ancestor** that existed before the recoded history.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INTRODUCTION

2 The writings of the human beings during the entire era of history have reflected the **culture lifestyle and the polity of contemporary society.**

3 In this process, **each culture evolved its own language and created a huge literary base.**

4 This enormous base of literature provides us a **glimpse of the evolution of each of its languages** and culture through the span of centuries.

5 These languages spoken around the various corners of India belong to several languages families where most of them belong to the Indo-Aryan Group of Languages.

6 This **Indo-Aryan group has been born out of the Indo-European Family.** However, there are some language groups which are indigenous to the Indian Sub-continent.



LANGUAGES IN INDIA

CLASSIFICATION OF INDIAN LANGUAGES

Languages in India are classified into the following major sub groups



LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INDO-ARYAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES



- 1 It is branch of the layer Indo-European family which came to India with the **advent of the Aryans**.
- 2 It is the largest language group of India and **around 74% of the Indians** speak the languages which belong to this group.
- 3 This language group is again subdivided into three groups depending upon the **time period** of their origin:
 - **Old** Indo-Aryan group
 - **Middle** Indo-Aryan group
 - **Modern** Indo-Aryan group

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INDO-ARYAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES

OLD INDO-ARYAN GROUP

- 1 This group had its development around 1500 B.C and Sanskrit was born out of this group.
- 2 The ancient form of Sanskrit is what we find in the Vedas.
- 3 Even Upanishads, Puranas and Dharmasutras were all written in Sanskrit.
- 4 It can be said that Sanskrit is the mother of many Indian languages.
- 5 The understanding of the diversity and richness of our culture has been possible all because of the development of Sanskrit language during those times.
- 6 It is the most ancient language of our country and is one of the 22 languages listed in the Constitution.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INDO-ARYAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES

I. OLD INDO-ARYAN GROUP

DEVELOPMENT OF SANSKRIT

- 1 The development of Sanskrit grammar began with Panini in 400 B.C. with his book *Asthadhyayi* being the oldest book in Sanskrit grammar.



- 2 Some of the Buddhist literature belonging to Mahayana and the Hinayana school are even written in Sanskrit language.

Eg 1

Lalitvistara, the most sacred Mahayana text was also written in Sanskrit language.

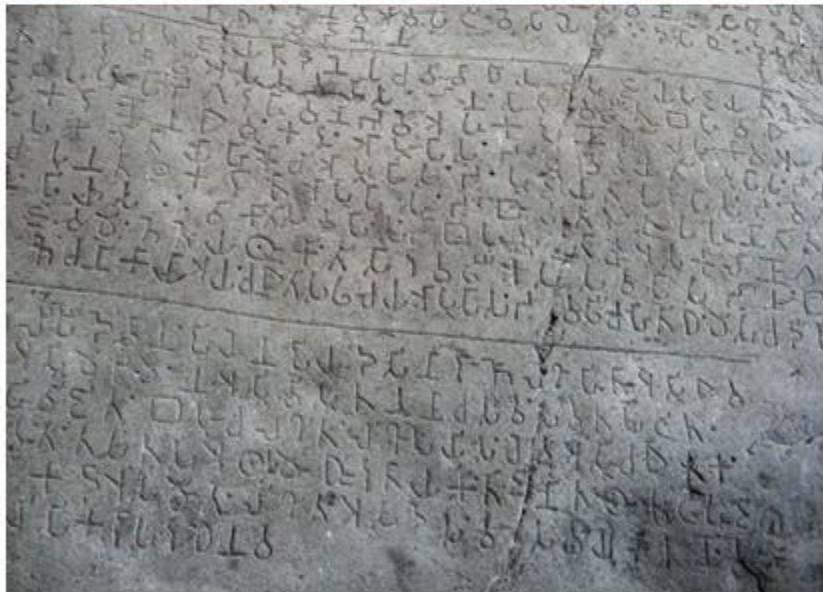
LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INDO-ARYAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES

I. OLD INDO-ARYAN GROUP

DEVELOPMENT OF SANSKRIT

- 3** Sanskrit is the only language that transcended the barriers of region and boundaries.



- 4** From north to south and from east to west, there is no part in India that has not contributed to or been affected by the Sanskrit language.
- 5** The **chaste form of Sanskrit** developed in between 300 BC to 200 BC. It was a **refined version of Vedic Sanskrit**.
- 6** The first evidence of the use of Sanskrit can be found in the inscriptions of **Rudradamana at Junagarh** in the present southern Gujarat region.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INDO-ARYAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES

DEVELOPMENT OF SANSKRIT

I. OLD INDO-ARYAN GROUP

- 7 However, it was the **Gupta Period** when the use of Sanskrit in poetries can be traced.
- 8 This is totally a period of creation of pure literature which is evident in the works as **Mahakavyas** (epics) and **Khandakavyas** (semi-epics).
- 9 In the field of Sanskrit literature, this period is known as the **period of unique creation**.

- 10 This is because of the fact that there has been a variety of literary works developed during this reign.
- 11 However, it is to be noted that one of the features of these places developed during the Gupta Period was the **use of Sanskrit language by the people of high varna and the use of Prakrit language by women and shudras**.

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INDO-ARYAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES

DEVELOPMENT OF PRAKRIT

II. MIDDLE INDO-ARYAN GROUP

- 1 The period of development of this sub-group is between 600 BC to 1000 AD.
- 2 Prakrit was the language which originally belonged to this group and thereafter many languages such as Pali, Apabhramsha, Ardha-magadhi found their origin from Prakrit language.
- 3 Prakrit and Ardha-magadhi language were used in the Jaina text. Prakrit was associated with the common people.
- 4 An important stage in the development of Prakrit was Paishachi and the last stage of the development of Prakrit laid to the development of Apabhramsha.
- 5 Some of the important literary works in Prakrit language are Gathasaptasati written by Hala.
- 6 Secular texts were also written in Prakrit language and are ethical in nature.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INDO-ARYAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES

DEVELOPMENT OF PRAKRIT

II. MIDDLE INDO-ARYAN GROUP



Some of the important Buddhist texts in Pali language are Vinayapitaka, Suttapitaka and Abhidhammapitaka.

- 7 The use of **Apabhramsha** was mainly found in the **local texts and folk literature**.
- 8 **Pali** which was also born out of Prakriti was the main language used in the **Buddhist** scripts.
- 9 Even Buddha used to give his preachings in Pali language.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

INDO-ARYAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES

III. MODERN INDO-ARYAN GROUP



मराठी
MARATHI

- 1 The language belonging to this group are Hindi, Assamese, Bengali, Gujarati, Marathi, Punjabi, Rajasthani, Sindhi, Odia, Urdu etc.
- 2 The languages under this sub group developed after 1000 AD.
- 3 These languages are mainly spoken in the northern, western and eastern parts of India.

DRAVIDIAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES



- 1 This group comprises mainly of the languages spoken in the southern part of India.
- 2 Around 25% of the Indian population is covered under this group.
- 3 Dravidian Languages can be broadly classified into three groups: Northern group, Central group and Southern group.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

DRAVIDIAN GROUP OF LANGUAGES

NORTHERN GROUP

- It consists of three languages i.e. Brahui, Malto and Kurukh.
- ✓ Brahui is spoken in Baluchistan,
- ✓ Malto in the tribal areas of Bengal and Odisha
- ✓ Kurukh in Bengal, Odisha and Bihar and Madhya Pradesh.

CENTRAL GROUP

- It consists of eleven languages i.e. Gondi, Khond, Kui, Manda, Parji, Gadaba, Kolami, Pengo, Naiki, Kuvi and Telugu.
- Only **Telugu** became a civilized language and is spoken in the State of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana whereas others are tribal languages.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

DRAVIDIAN GROUP

SOUTHERN GROUP

தமிழ்
தேலுగు கன்னட
மலையாளம்

1 Seven languages belong to this group. They are **Kannada, Tamil, Malayalam, Tulu, Kodagu, Toda and Kota**. Tamil is the oldest among all these.

2 Among these 21 languages of the Dravidian Group, the four major languages of the Dravidian group are:

- Telugu (numerically the largest of all Dravidian languages)
- Tamil (oldest and purest form of language)
- Kannada
- Malayalam (Smallest and the youngest of the Dravidian group).

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

SINO-TIBETAN GROUP



1 Languages under this group belong to **Mongoloid family** and stretch to **all over the Himalayas, North Bihar, North Bengal, Assam and up to the North-Eastern frontiers of the nation.**

2 These languages are considered to be older than the Indo-Aryan languages and are referred to in the oldest Sanskrit literature as **Kiratas**.

3 0.6% of the Indian population speaks languages belonging to this group.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

SINO-TIBETAN GROUP

The Sino-Tibetan group is further divided into:

TIBETO-BURMAN

Languages under Tibeto-Burman are further divided into four groups:

- 1) **Tibetan :**
Sikkimese, Bhutia, Balti, Sherpa, Lahuli and Ladakhi.
- 2) **Himalayan :**
Kinnauri and Limbu
- 3) **North Assam :**
Abor, Miri, Aka, Dafla and Mishmi
- 4) **Assam :**
Burmese-Kuki-chin, Mikir, Bodo and Naga. Manipuri or Meithi is the most important languages spoken under Kuki Chin under the sub-group

SIAMESE-CHINESE

- **Ahom** is one of the languages belonging to this group.
- The language fell into complete disuse by the 19th century and the phonology has completely been lost.
- The language today is used chiefly for liturgical purposes and is no longer used in daily life.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

AUSTRIC

1 This is also referred to as the Mon-Khmer group of languages.

2 Languages under this group belong to Austro-Asiatic sub-family which are represented by the languages of **Munda or Kol group** and spoken in Central, Eastern and North-Eastern India.



3 The existence of these languages have been much before the advent of the Aryans and were referred to in ancient Sanskrit literature as **Nishadas**.

4 **Santhali** is the most important language under this group which is spoken among by **Santhal tribals** of Jharkhand, Bihar and Bengal.

5 With the exceptions of **Khasi** and **Santhali**, all Austro-Asiatic languages on Indian Territory are endangered.

OTHERS

This group includes several Dravidian Adivasi languages like Gondi, Oraon, Praji etc. which are very distinct and cannot be classified in the groups mentioned above.

Difference between Indo-Aryan Group and Dravidian Group of Languages :

- 1) *The root words in the two language families are different.*
- 2) *There is a different grammatical structure in the two groups.*
 - i. *Grammatical structure of Dravidian family is agglutinative i.e the combinations in which roots words are united with little or no change of form or loss of words.*
 - ii. *The grammatical structure of Indo-Aryan group is inflected i.e the ending words or its spelling changes according to its grammatical function in a sentence.*

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